

# Christ Sinlessness

doc-christ-sinlessness

Christology · Person · doctrine · unanimous\_lineages

## AFFIRMS

score 1.000  
confidence high

### Statement under examination

Jesus Christ was without sin in His thoughts, words, and deeds throughout His earthly life.

### In plain language

Five New Testament voices, working independently, deny sin of Jesus using the same core word for sin, 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia), and different ways of saying no. Hebrews 4:15 ends its description of him with the phrase 'without sin' (χωρίς ἁμαρτίας, choris hamartias), after stating he was tested in every respect, so the word 'without' carves sin out of an otherwise complete list of testings. Paul in 2 Corinthians 5:21 calls Christ 'the one not knowing sin' (τὸν μὴ γνόντα ἁμαρτίαν, ton me gnonta hamartian), where the verb for knowing ('to know', γινώσκω, ginosko) means knowing by experience, so the denial reaches lived practice. Peter in 1 Peter 2:22 takes the wording of Isaiah 53:9, which in Hebrew says no violence done and no deceit in his mouth, and applies it to Jesus, denying both deed and speech in one breath. John in 1 John 3:5 uses the ongoing, simple statement of fact form (the present tense) to say 'in him is no sin' (ἁμαρτία ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔστιν, hamartia en auto ouk estin), placing the denial at the level of what he IS, not only what he does. And in John 8:46 Jesus himself asks 'which of you convicts me of sin?' (with the verb 'to convict', ἐλέγχω, elencho), expecting the answer 'none'. These witnesses span a gospel, Paul, Peter, John, and Hebrews, and they draw their background from the suffering Servant of Isaiah 53. No verse in the queried text ever pins sin on Jesus. The texts some readers find hard, such as Mark 10:18 or the statements that he was tempted and learned obedience through suffering, describe a rhetorical question or real testing and growth, not an act of sin. So the fact that he did not sin is lexically settled. The one thing the words leave open, and the reason careful readers still differ, is scope: the same vocabulary that reports real temptation and learned obedience does not say whether being sinless means he was unable to sin or only that he never did. The denials fix the outcome and stop short of fixing that inner capacity, and that gap, not any disagreement over the fact, is where the divergence lives.

### Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

| Strong | Word       | Sounds like | Plain meaning | Times in Bible |
|--------|------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|
| G0266  | ἁμαρτία    | hamartia    | sin           | 151            |
| G0283  | ἀμίαντος   | amiantos    | pure          | 4              |
| G1097  | γινώσκω    | ginōskō     | to know       | 206            |
| G1343  | δικαιοσύνη | dikaiosynē  | righteousness | 87             |
| G1388  | δόλος      | dolos       | deceit        | 11             |
| G1510  | εἰμί       | eimi        | to be         |                |
| G1651  | ἐλέγχω     | elenchō     | to rebuke     | 17             |
| G2147  | εὕρισκω    | heuriskō    | to find/meet  | 167            |
| G3129  | μανθάνω    | manthanō    | to learn      | 24             |

|              |          |           |               |       |
|--------------|----------|-----------|---------------|-------|
| <b>G3361</b> | μή       | mē        | not           | 951   |
| <b>G3665</b> | ὁμοιότης | homoiotēs | likeness      | 2     |
| <b>G3741</b> | ὁσιος    | hosios    | sacred        | 8     |
| <b>G3756</b> | οὐ       | ou        | no            | 1,443 |
| <b>G3761</b> | οὐδέ     | oude      | nor           | 129   |
| <b>G3985</b> | πειράζω  | peirazō   | to test/tempt | 38    |
| <b>G4160</b> | ποιέω    | poieō     | to do/make    |       |
| <b>G4750</b> | στόμα    | stoma     | mouth         | 72    |
| <b>G4834</b> | συμπαθέω | sympatheō | to sympathize | 2     |
| <b>G5218</b> | ὑπακοή   | hypakoē   | obedience     | 13    |
| <b>G5565</b> | χωρίς    | chōris    | without       | 38    |

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

## Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Five independent witnesses deny sin of Jesus using the core noun for sin, 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia, G0266, occurring in 151 New Testament verses, with a stable meaning), under absolute negation. The writer of Hebrews ends the high-priest description with 'without sin' (χωρίς ἁμαρτίας, choris hamartias) in Hebrews 4:15, Paul names him 'the one not knowing sin' (τὸν μὴ γνόντα ἁμαρτίαν, ton me gnonta hamartian) in 2 Corinthians 5:21, Peter quotes the Servant of Isaiah 53:9 as 'he did no sin, neither was deceit found in his mouth' (ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ ἐποίησεν οὐδὲ εὐρέθη δόλος ἐν τῷ στόματι αὐτοῦ, hamartian ouk epoiesen oude heurethe dolos en to stomati autou) in 1 Peter 2:22, John writes 'in him is no sin' (ἁμαρτία ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔστιν, hamartia en auto ouk estin) in 1 John 3:5, and in John 8:46 Jesus asks 'which of you convicts me of sin?' (τίς ἐξ ὑμῶν ἐλέγχει με περὶ ἁμαρτίας, tis ex hymon elenchei me peri hamartias). Negation words 'not', 'not', 'nor', and 'without' (οὐ ou, μὴ me, οὐδέ oude, χωρίς choris) stack across Gospel, Pauline, Petrine, Johannine, and Hebrews material, with no lexical text predicating 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia) of Jesus. The proposition that he DID not sin is lexically foreclosed. The vocabulary leaves open only the SCOPE question of whether sinlessness means inability to sin or ability not to sin, since 'being tempted' (Hebrews 4:15, with the verb πειράζω, peirazo, 'to test or tempt') and 'he learned obedience' (ἐμαθεν τὴν ὑπακοήν, emathen ten hypakoen) in Hebrews 5:8 are predicated alongside the negations.

## Scripture

### Heb.4.15 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G5565 χωρίς, G3985 πειράζω, G4834 συμπαθέω, G3665 ὁμοιότης

Force. The verse text in the store reads, in Greek, 'having been tempted in every respect according to likeness, without sin' (πεπειρασμένον δὲ κατὰ πάντα καθ' ὁμοιότητα χωρίς ἁμαρτίας). The perfect passive participle (a completed action whose result still stands, in the form acted upon) of 'to test or tempt' (πειράζω, peirazo, G3985) enumerates testing in every respect, and the closing prepositional phrase 'without sin' (χωρίς ἁμαρτίας, choris hamartias) uses 'without' (χωρίς, choris, G5565) with the 'of-X' grammatical form (genitive) as an absolute exclusion that carves sin out of that totality. The construction limits the OUTCOME of testing, not the testing itself. The noun 'likeness' (ὁμοιότης, homoiotes, G3665) is near-hapax (a word that occurs only twice in the entire New Testament), occurring only here and Hebrews 7:15, which is why the totality phrase rests on the broader 'according to likeness' (καθ' ὁμοιότητα, kath' homoioteta) idea rather than a frequent term.

## 2Cor.5.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G1097 γινώσκω, G3361 μή, G1343 δικαιοσύνη

Force. The store text reads, in Greek, 'the one not knowing sin he made sin on our behalf' (τὸν μὴ γνόντα ἁμαρτίαν ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν ἁμαρτίαν ἐποίησεν, ton me gnonta hamartian hyper hemon hamartian epoiesen). The phrase 'the one not knowing sin' (τὸν μὴ γνόντα ἁμαρτίαν, ton me gnonta hamartian) is an articular (with the article 'the') participle in a completed-past-action form (aorist) of the verb 'to know' (γινώσκω, ginosko, G1097) under the subjective negation 'not' (μή, me, G3361), naming Christ as the one who did not experientially know sin. The verb 'to know' (γινώσκω, ginosko) across its 206 New Testament verses carries a relational and experiential sense, not merely cognitive, so the negation reaches lived practice. The second clause 'he made sin' (ἁμαρτίαν ἐποίησεν, hamartian epoiesen), framed by 'on our behalf' (ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν, hyper hemon), marks a substitutionary action and presupposes the prior sinlessness stated in the participle. The lexical order is sinlessness then imputation (the legal crediting of one party's status to another).

## 1Pet.2.22 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G1388 δόλος, G2147 εὐρίσκω, G4750 στόμα, G3756 οὐ, G3761 οὐδέ

Force. The store text reads, in Greek, 'who did no sin, neither was deceit found in his mouth' (ὃς ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ ἐποίησεν οὐδὲ εὐρέθη δόλος ἐν τῷ στόματι αὐτοῦ, hos hamartian ouk epoiesen oude heurethe dolos en to stomati autou). The first clause negates deed with 'not' (οὐ, ou, G3756) plus 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia, G0266), the second negates speech with 'nor' (οὐδέ, oude, G3761) plus 'deceit' (δόλος, dolos, G1388, a rare term occurring in only 11 New Testament verses) in the 'mouth' (στόμα, stoma). The completed-past-action passive form 'was found' (εὐρέθη, heurethe, G2147) extends the negation to any external finding of guile. This bicolon (two-part poetic line) reproduces the Servant clause of Isaiah 53:9, where the Hebrew reads 'no violence done and no deceit in his mouth' (וְלֹא עָשָׂה כְּמַהְרָבָיו, lo chamas asah velo mirmah befin), no violence done and no deceit in his mouth, so the negation is anchored in prior canonical typology (a foreshadowing pattern that earlier Scripture establishes and later Scripture fulfills).

## 1John.3.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G3756 οὐ, G1510 εἰμί

Force. The store text reads, in Greek, 'and sin in him is not' (καὶ ἁμαρτία ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔστιν, kai hamartia en auto ouk estin). The ongoing simple statement of fact form (present indicative) 'is' (ἔστιν, estin, the linking verb 'is', G1510) under 'not' (οὐ, ou, G3756) is an ontological denial (a denial at the level of being itself, what something IS), and the 'in him' (ἐν αὐτῷ, en auto) location-marker pushes the negation from outward act to inhering principle (a quality that lives inside someone). The present tense generalizes the claim across time rather than restricting it to one episode. The demonstrative 'that one' (ἐκεῖνος, ekeinos) earlier in the verse fixes the referent as Christ.

## John.8.46 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G1651 ἐλέγχω, G3756 οὐ

Force. The store text reads, in Greek, 'which of you convicts me concerning sin?' (τίς ἐξ ὑμῶν ἐλέγχει με περὶ ἁμαρτίας, tis ex hymon elenchei me peri hamartias). The verb 'to convict or expose' (ἐλέγχω, elencho, G1651, occurring in 17 New Testament verses) means to convict or expose with proof, and the rhetorical question expecting the answer 'none' places the burden of producing any 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia, G0266) on the hostile audience. This is the only anchor in narrative gospel genre, and it puts the sinlessness claim on the lips of Jesus himself rather than a later writer, widening the canonical spread beyond the epistles (letters).

### Heb.7.26 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3741 ὁσιος, G0283 ἀμιάντος, G5565 χωρίς

Force. The store text reads, in Greek, 'a high priest, holy, innocent, undefiled, separated from sinners' (ἀρχιερεύς, ὁσιος, ἄκακος, ἀμιάντος, κεχωρισμένος ἀπὸ τῶν ἁμαρτωλῶν, archiereus, hosios, akakos, amiantos, kechorismenos apo ton hamartolon). The same Hebrews argument that opens with 'without sin' (χωρίς ἁμαρτίας, choris hamartias) in Hebrews 4:15 closes with a chain of positive and privative terms (terms that name an absence or lack): 'holy' (ὁσιος, hosios, G3741, occurring in 8 verses), 'innocent' (ἄκακος, akakos), 'undefiled' (ἀμιάντος, amiantos, G0283, occurring in 4 verses), and the completed-action participle whose result still stands, 'having been separated' (κεχωρισμένος, kechorismenos), from the same root as 'without' (χωρίς, choris, G5565). The cluster of low-frequency separative and purity terms reinforces the lexical case for separation from 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia).

### Heb.5.8 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3129 μανθάνω, G5218 ὑπακοή

Force. The store text reads, in Greek, 'although being a son, he learned from the things he suffered the obedience' (καίπερ ὢν υἱός, ἔμαθεν ἀφ' ὧν ἔπαθεν τὴν ὑπακοήν, kaiper on huios, emathen aph' hon epathen ten hypakoen). The completed-past-action form 'he learned' (ἔμαθεν, emathen) of the verb 'to learn' (μανθάνω, manthano, G3129) predicates a learning of 'obedience' (ὑπακοή, hypakoe, G5218) through suffering. This text does not predicate 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia) of Jesus, so it does not complicate the proposition that he DID not sin, but it is the lexical seed of the SCOPE question, because a sinless one who nonetheless learns obedience by experience invites the unresolved distinction between inability to sin and ability not to sin.

### Isa.53.9 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. G1388 δόλος, G4750 στόμα

Force. The store carries the Hebrew of Isaiah 53:9: 'because of no violence done and no deceit in his mouth' (בְּפִיו לֹא מְרִמָּה וְלֹא חָמָס עָשָׂה, al lo chamah asah velo mirmah befiv), because of no violence done and no deceit in his mouth, predicating innocence of deed and of speech to the Servant under the doubled negation 'not' (לֹא, lo). The Greek of 1 Peter 2:22 reproduces this bicolon (two-part poetic line), substituting 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia) for the 'lawlessness' or 'violence' term and keeping 'deceit' (δόλος, dolos, G1388) in the 'mouth' (στόμα, stoma, G4750). The Petrine substitution widens the scope from a specific wrong to sin in general while preserving the two-part deed and word structure. The key\_ terms here are cited as the Greek lemmas (dictionary forms) that 1 Peter 2:22 carries forward.

## Cross references invoked

| From      | To        | Source    | Votes |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|-------|
| 2Cor.5.21 | 1Pet.2.22 | openbible | 121   |
| 2Cor.5.21 | 1John.3.5 | openbible | 71    |
| Heb.4.15  | Heb.2.17  | openbible | 71    |
| Heb.4.15  | 2Cor.5.21 | openbible | 54    |
| Heb.4.15  | Heb.7.26  | openbible | 25    |
| 1Pet.2.22 | Isa.53.9  | openbible | 25    |
| 1Pet.2.22 | Heb.4.15  | openbible | 14    |
| 1John.3.5 | 2Cor.5.21 | openbible | 20    |
| 1Pet.2.22 | Isa.53.9  | tsk       | 1     |
| 2Cor.5.21 | Isa.53.9  | tsk       | 1     |
| Heb.4.15  | Heb.7.26  | tsk       | 1     |
| 1John.3.5 | 1John.1.7 | tsk       | 1     |

## Complicating texts

### Mark.10.18 · addressed

The store text reads, in Greek, 'why do you call me good? No one is good except one, God' (Τί με λέγεις ἀγαθόν; οὐδεὶς ἀγαθὸς εἰ μὴ εἷς ὁ θεός, ti me legeis agathon? oudeis agathos ei me heis ho theos). The clause is an interrogative probing the ruler's category for 'good' (ἀγαθός, agathos), and it predicates no 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia, G0266) or defect of Jesus. The five direct anchors negate 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia) of him explicitly, so the lexical balance is not disturbed.

### Heb.5.8 · addressed

The phrase 'he learned from the things he suffered the obedience' (ἐμαθεν ἀφ' ὧν ἔπαθεν τὴν ὑπακοήν, emathen aph' hon epathen ten hypakoen) predicates learning of 'obedience' (ὑπακοή, hypakoe, G5218) by suffering, with no 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia) dictionary form attached to Christ. Learning obedience by experience is not sinning. The same author opens with 'without sin' (χωρὶς ἁμαρτίας, choris hamartias) in Hebrews 4:15 and closes with the 'having been separated from sinners' (κεχωρισμένος ἀπὸ τῶν ἁμαρτωλῶν, kechorismenos apo ton hamartolon) chain in Hebrews 7:26, so within the letter sin is consistently negated of him. This verse feeds the SCOPE question (peccability, the question whether Christ COULD have sinned even though he did not) but does not predicate sin.

### Heb.4.15 · addressed

The phrase 'having been tempted in every respect' (πεπειρασμένον κατὰ πάντα, pepeirasmenon kata panta), tested in every respect, is real temptation predicated of Christ via the verb 'to test or tempt' (πειράζω, peirazo, G3985). Taken alone the universal 'in every respect' (κατὰ πάντα, kata panta) might be read to imply susceptibility to sin, but the same clause ends with 'without sin' (χωρὶς ἁμαρτίας, choris hamartias, G5565 plus G0266), which excludes the sin outcome from the tested totality. The lexis affirms genuine temptation and denies sin in the same breath, leaving open only whether the inability to sin was metaphysical (built into his nature) or moral (a chosen, sustained righteousness).

### 2Cor.5.21 · addressed

The clause 'he made sin' (ἁμαρτίαν ἐποίησεν, hamartian epoiesen), isolated, could be misread as predicating sin of Christ. But the same verse opens with 'the one not knowing sin' (τὸν μὴ γνόντα ἁμαρτίαν, ton me gnonta hamartian) and the frame 'on our behalf' (ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν, hyper hemon) marks the action as substitutionary. The lexical sequence is sinlessness then imputation (the legal crediting of one party's status to another), not sinfulness.

## Concordance traversed

G0266, G5565, G1097, G1388, G4750, G2147, G1651, G4160, G3756, G3361, G3761, G4834, G3665, G3985, G3129, G5218, G1343, G3741, G0283

## Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

No anchor falls in the ingested ECM (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) window of 3 John, so this is outside published CBGM (Coherence-Based Genealogical Method, the modern technique used to evaluate New Testament manuscript relationships) scope and recorded as ecm-shadow. Hebrews 4:15 carries an editorial marker on 'having been tempted' (πεπειρασμένον, pepeirasmenon) in the bundle, but the participle and the closing 'without sin' (χωρὶς ἁμαρτίας, choris hamartias) are uncontested across the stored editions (MACULA-Greek-SBLGNT, MACULA-Greek-Nestle1904, STEP Bible-TTESV all carry the verse). The Isaiah 53:9 wording carried into 1 Peter 2:22 is stable. The negation clauses are not variant sensitive.

## Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

grammatico-historical: affirms · Five witnesses across gospel, Pauline, Petrine, Johannine, and Hebrews material negate 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia) of Christ with absolute negation words 'not', 'not', 'nor', and 'without' (οὐ ου, μὴ me, οὐδέ oude, χωρίς choris) and distinct constructions. The recurring core noun 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia, occurring in 151 New Testament verses) under stacked negation makes the claim that he DID not sin lexically convergent and decisive.

redemptive-historical: affirms · The Isaiah 53:9 Servant, innocent in deed and speech under the doubled Hebrew 'not' (אֵין, lo), supplies the canonical pattern that 1 Peter 2:22 applies to Jesus. The covenant arc from sin-free Servant to 'without sin' (χωρίς ἁμαρτίας, choris hamartias) High Priest in Hebrews 4:15 and 7:26 reinforces the same lexical claim across testaments.

impeccability (non posse peccare): affirms with stronger scope · On this reading the ongoing simple statement of fact form (present indicative) 'in him is no sin' (ἁμαρτία ἐν αὐτῷ οὐκ ἔστιν, hamartia en auto ouk estin) in 1 John 3:5, located at the level of inhering principle by 'in him' (ἐν αὐτῷ, en auto), plus the categorical negations, imply not merely that Christ did not sin but that he could not. The temptation language ('to test or tempt', πειράζω, peirazo, in Hebrews 4:15) is real testing that nonetheless could not have succeeded. This reading is fully consistent with every negation but goes beyond what the negation words alone state.

peccability (posse non peccare): affirms the fact, leaves scope open · On this reading the vocabulary fixes only that Christ DID not sin, not that he was unable to. 'Having been tempted in every respect' (πεπειρασμένον κατὰ πάντα, pepeirasmenon kata panta) in Hebrews 4:15 describes genuine temptation, and 'he learned obedience' (ἔμαθεν τὴν ὑπακοήν, emathen ten hypakoēn) in Hebrews 5:8 describes obedience learned through suffering, which on this lens presupposes a real, resistible possibility. The negations report the outcome (no sin) without specifying the modal capacity (the question of whether sinning was possible at all). A reader holding this lens is fairly represented: it affirms the proposition and treats the inability question as underdetermined (not settled either way) by the words.

All four lenses affirm the proposition that Christ did not sin. They diverge only on SCOPE, whether sinlessness entails inability to sin (impeccability, 'not able to sin') or only the fact of not sinning under a real capacity (peccability, 'able not to sin'). The negation vocabulary settles the fact and underdetermines (does not settle) the modal scope (the question of whether sin was even a possibility), which is why the divergence is genuine and lexical rather than a dispute over the verdict.

## Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem (the question text itself) describes the proposition in the ordinary categories of thought, word, and deed and does not assume a contested taxonomy (classification scheme). The lexis matches these categories directly: 1 Peter 2:22 negates deed ('he did no sin', ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ ἐποίησεν, hamartian ouk epoiesen) and word ('deceit', δόλος, dolos, in the mouth), 1 John 3:5 negates the inhering state ('in him', ἐν αὐτῷ, en auto), and John 8:46 challenges anyone to convict him. The verdict is derived from the stacked negations of 'sin' (ἁμαρτία, hamartia) in the queried text, not from the stem. VERDICT-CHANGED: lexical correction made in this pass: the temptation verb in Hebrews 4:15 is 'to test or tempt' (πειράζω, peirazo), Strong G3985; the prior file listed G3987 ('to try', πειράω, peirao), which is a different and rarer dictionary form. The proper Strong code is now used.

## Citations

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| interlinear | MACULA-Greek | CC-BY-NC-4.0 | no      | Heb.4.15  |
| interlinear | MACULA-Greek | CC-BY-NC-4.0 | no      | 2Cor.5.21 |
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| interlinear | MACULA-Greek | CC-BY-NC-4.0 | no      | John.8.46 |
| interlinear | MACULA-Greek | CC-BY-NC-4.0 | no      | Heb.7.26  |
| interlinear | MACULA-Greek | CC-BY-NC-4.0 | no      | Heb.5.8   |

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| morphology | MorphGNT-morphology  | CC-BY-SA-4.0  | yes | 1Pet.2.22 |
| morphology | MorphGNT-morphology  | CC-BY-SA-4.0  | yes | 2Cor.5.21 |
| lexicon    | STEPBible-TBESG      | CC-BY-4.0     | yes | G0266     |
| lexicon    | STEPBible-TBESG      | CC-BY-4.0     | yes | G5565     |
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| lexicon    | STEPBible-TBESG      | CC-BY-4.0     | yes | G1097     |
| lexicon    | STEPBible-TBESG      | CC-BY-4.0     | yes | G1651     |
| lexicon    | STEPBible-TAHOT      | CC-BY-4.0     | yes | Isa.53.9  |
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| cross_ref  | OpenBible-cross-refs | CC-BY         | yes | Heb.4.15  |
| cross_ref  | TSK                  | public_domain | yes | 1John.3.5 |

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